The January 2026 INDIA TODAY Mood of the Nation survey offers a portrait of an India that is negotiating change with confidence, anxiety and conditional trust. Across questions on work, technology, infrastructure, social cohesion, governance and the environment, a consistent pattern emerges: Indians are open to change, impatient with dysfunction and precise about where responsibility lies.

That pragmatism is visible in how Indians view employment. Central to that are the new Labour Codes—an overhaul that folded 29 central labour laws into four broad frameworks covering wages, industrial relations, social security and occupational safety. These are meant to formalise employment, reduce compliance friction and extend social security to informal workers. However, the new codes are greeted with scepticism. Over a quarter of the respondents (26.3 per cent) believe the codes help both labour and business, yet many either see them as tilted towards business (23.1 per cent), labour (16.5 per cent) or altogether ineffective (18.1 per cent). This shows how contractualisation, job insecurity and weak grievance-redressal temper optimism.

Indeed, nearly one in three respondents fears Artificial Intelligence will take away her job, while 22.3 per cent believe parts of jobs will disappear. This concern coexists with huge support (65.4 per cent) for a legal 'right to disconnect' from work, as proposed in Parliament.

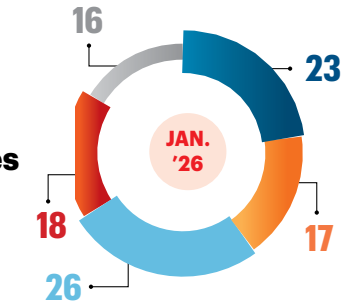
Infrastructure-creation remains a visible strength for the NDA government. Ratings for roads and infrastructure show a steady improvement, with 'excellent' assessments rising to 24 per cent in January 2026, up from 20 per cent in August 2025 and 21.7 per cent in February 2025. This upward movement is accompanied by a gradual erosion of negative sentiment, as 'poor' and 'very poor' ratings continue to edge down.

50 PER CENT of those surveyed said roads in India are either excellent or good

Public transport in urban India shows a more modest but still positive trajectory. While 'excellent' ratings at 17.4 per cent are broadly stable compared to earlier rounds, the decline in 'very poor' assessments—from 9.6 per cent in February 2025 to 6.6 per cent in January 2026—suggests incremental improvement rather than a dramatic turnaround.

The National Education Policy 2020 was unveiled with sweeping ambition, overhauling curricula and promising a structural reset, especially for school education long plagued by learning deficits. A majority of the MOTN respondents are willing—very or somewhat likely—to send children or relatives to government schools. An income-based split is evident, with 39 per cent of lower-income respondents open to government schools, versus only 20 per

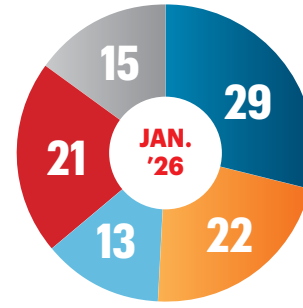
Q. What do you think of the new Labour Codes governing work for employees?



They help business, not labour
They help labour, but not business
They help both labour and business
They don't make a difference
DK/ CS

A quarter of the respondents say the codes favour both labour and business, but an equal minority think they favour one or the other

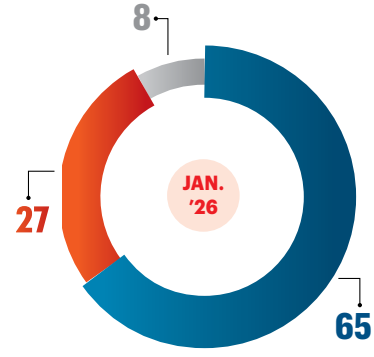
Q. Do you think AI will take away your job?



A majority believe that AI would bring a big change in their employment status

Yes
Possibly, some parts of my job
No, but my role will change
No, no impact
DK/ CS

Q. MP Supriya Sule's bill in Parliament says employees should not be forced to reply to work calls after office hours. Do you think India needs such a law to protect work-life balance?



Yes, employees should have the right to switch off after work, so they can rest and reduce stress
No, such a law is not needed and may affect work efficiency or business flexibility
DK/ CS

An overwhelming majority of respondents support better work-life balance

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say